

August 2026

Dear Sandra,

I've sold a lot of homes in Lafayette over the years, and certain properties have a way of standing out the moment you walk in. The combination at 53 Hidden Oaks Drive is genuinely rare: Venetian plaster walls, a 2,000-bottle wine cellar with a dedicated tasting room, resort-caliber grounds, and 5,300 square feet of thoughtfully finished living space all on nearly an acre. When I saw the listing come off market at \$4,295,000 without a sale after 98 days, I wanted to reach out directly.

Ninety-eight days is a long run for a home with this much going for it, and the gap between the listing's genuine assets and its outcome tells me the strategy didn't keep pace with the property. A home at this level requires a buyer pool that isn't just browsing the MLS, it requires active outreach to the specific buyers who understand what a private bocce court, an outdoor kitchen with a Lynx pizza oven, and a wine cellar of this caliber are actually worth. The listing description covered the features, but a description alone doesn't close the distance between a qualified buyer in San Francisco and a showing in Lafayette.

I've put together a report that walks through three specific places where the listing strategy and this home's actual strengths didn't connect, along with a clear framework for how a relaunch could be structured differently. It's not a generic pitch. It's an analysis of this particular property and what it would take to reach the right buyer at the right number.

If you're already working with an agent toward a new listing, please feel free to set this aside, no hard feelings at all. If you're not, I'd welcome the chance to walk you through what I've prepared. A twenty-minute conversation is all it would take.

With respect,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Ben Olsen', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Ben Olsen

REALTOR · BrightWork Realty Advocates
(925) 255-9727 · brightworkrealty.com
455 Moraga Road, Suite I · Moraga, CA 94556

The Path to Sold:

53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Lafayette, CA 94549

4.0 Beds · 5 Baths · 5,300 Sq Ft · Lafayette

The Blueprint for a Successful Sale

Prepared For: The Owners of 53 Hidden Oaks Dr

Presented By: Ben Olsen · BrightWork Realty Advocates

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A Fully Finished Lafayette Estate with Resort Grounds and a Collector's Wine Cellar - and a Listing That Didn't Reach Its Buyer

53 Hidden Oaks Drive is a genuinely exceptional property: 5,300 square feet built in 2006, Venetian plaster finishes throughout, an executive office with rich paneling, a primary suite with a private balcony and spa bath, and a wine cellar capable of housing over 2,000 bottles with a dedicated tasting room. The outdoor setting is equally serious, with a pool, spa, bocce court, fire pit, a full outdoor kitchen anchored by a Lynx pizza oven and DCS BBQ, and nearly a full acre of grounds. Owned solar, dual generators, copper gutters, and a three-car garage with epoxy floors round out a home that presents as ready for a discerning buyer, not a project.

At \$4,295,000 and \$810 per square foot, the pricing sits in a defensible position for a property of this finish level, but 98 days on market without a sale points to a strategy gap rather than a value problem. Buyers at this price point in Lafayette are selective and well-informed. They research extensively online before they ever schedule a showing, and they respond to listings that give them enough visual depth and narrative context to justify the drive. A standard MLS approach, even with a strong description, rarely has the reach to find and convert buyers at this level on its own.

\$4,295,000

List Price

\$810/sqft

Price Per Sq. Ft.

None

HOA Fees

A relaunch for this home needs to close the gap between what the property genuinely delivers and what buyers experienced when they encountered the listing. That means reaching the right buyer profile actively, presenting the home's visual character at a level that matches its finish quality, and building a narrative that explains exactly what \$810 per square foot buys here that you simply cannot find elsewhere in Lafayette.

MARKET FORENSICS: WHY IT DIDN'T SELL

Every expired listing has a story. Here's what the listing history tells us about what held this one back, and what a different strategy would have done.

Friction #1: 98 Days and a Buyer Pool That Was Never Actively Reached

After 98 days on the market, the listing crossed a threshold that works against even the best properties. Past the 45-day mark, buyers stop evaluating a home on its merits and start asking what everyone else saw wrong with it. That shift in perception wasn't earned by 53 Hidden Oaks Drive. The wine cellar, the resort grounds, the Venetian plaster finishes, these are not features that age poorly. What aged was a distribution strategy that waited for the right buyer to find the listing rather than finding the buyer. At \$4.295 million, the buyer pool is smaller and more deliberate, which means passive distribution produces a much slower funnel. The home needed to be placed in front of qualified buyers who were still in the research phase, before they had already committed to something else.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork runs geo-targeted digital campaigns that reach San Francisco and East Bay buyers who are actively researching Lamorinda before they've decided on a specific home, putting 53 Hidden Oaks Drive in front of the right people well before they've scrolled past it.

Friction #2: A Visual Story That Didn't Match the Property's Actual Character

A wine cellar with 2,000-bottle capacity and a dedicated tasting room is not a standard feature. Neither is a Lynx pizza oven, a bocce court with string lighting, or Venetian plaster that runs through an entire 5,300-square-foot home. These are details that require the right visual presentation to register as premiums rather than curiosities in a portal thumbnail. When a buyer at this price point encounters a listing that doesn't visually communicate the depth of what's inside, they move on before they ever consider scheduling a showing. The listing description did name these features, but a buyer comparing options on Zillow experiences the photography first, not the words. If the visual package didn't convey the tasting room, the outdoor kitchen setting, and the estate-scale grounds in a way that stopped the scroll, the description never got read.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's 3D Matterport tour lets buyers walk through the wine cellar, the outdoor kitchen, and every room of the home from anywhere, at any time, giving out-of-area buyers the visual depth to understand exactly what they're considering before they commit to a

Friction #3: Portal Visibility That Didn't Match the Price Point

At \$4,295,000, this home was competing against a small number of properties for a small number of buyers. In that environment, portal placement matters enormously. A standard listing on Zillow puts 53 Hidden Oaks Drive alongside dozens of competing homes, with buyer inquiries frequently routed to agents who have no relationship with the property and no stake in presenting it accurately. Buyers who inquire through a third-party agent often get a generic response, and the momentum of their interest evaporates before it becomes a showing. The listing needed a presence on Zillow that kept buyer inquiries inside the listing team and gave the property a premium position at the top of the search results where serious buyers are looking.

* THE BRIGHTWORK DIFFERENCE

BrightWork's Zillow Showcase placement gives this home enhanced listing pages with premium portal visibility and routes all buyer inquiries directly back to the listing team, so every interested buyer gets a response from someone who actually knows the property.

POSITIONING ANALYSIS

Metric	53 Hidden Oaks Dr	Lafayette Market Context
Price per Sq. Ft.	\$810/sqft	Premium tier: \$850–\$920/sqft; Renovated tier: \$780–\$840/sqft
Lot / Setting	0.90 acres, resort-style grounds with pool, spa, bocce court, fire pit, and full outdoor kitchen	Typical Lafayette lot: 0.25–0.50 acres, standard landscaping
Architectural Character	2006 custom build with Venetian plaster walls and ceilings, hand-scraped hardwood floors, formal entry with soaring ceilings, richly paneled executive office	Standard updated inventory: builder-grade finishes, conventional layout
Premium Features	2,000-bottle wine cellar with tasting room, owned solar, dual generators, copper gutters, three-car garage with epoxy floors, outdoor kitchen with Lynx pizza oven and DCS BBQ	Standard floor plan: single-car or two-car garage, no wine storage, no outdoor kitchen
HOA	None	None typical for Lafayette single-family

The verdict: At \$810/sqft versus a benchmark range of \$850-\$920/sqft, this home sits near the lower end of that range. At \$810 per square foot, 53 Hidden Oaks Drive sits at the lower end of the renovated tier and meaningfully below the premium tier range, despite delivering finish quality, lot scale, and amenities that are firmly in premium territory. That gap is actually an argument in favor of the pricing, not against it, but only if the marketing builds the case for it. A buyer comparing this home against others at \$850 to \$920 per square foot needs to understand specifically what the extra land, the wine cellar, the outdoor kitchen, and the custom finishes represent in real terms. The strategy needed to make that argument proactively rather than leaving buyers to draw their own conclusions.

THE RELAUNCH STRATEGY: 3 PILLARS

We don't re-list this home. We relaunch it with new media, a narrative that finally does it justice, and distribution designed for the buyer it deserves.

Pillar I - Reaching the Buyer Who Can Say Yes to \$4.295 Million

The buyer for 53 Hidden Oaks Drive is not browsing casually. They are a qualified professional, likely coming from San Francisco or the broader East Bay, who is actively researching Lamorinda and comparing a small number of serious options. A relaunch strategy needs to reach that person before they've committed to something else, which means active digital outreach beyond the MLS. BrightWork's geo-targeted campaigns are built precisely for this, placing the home in front of buyers while they are still in the research phase and before the Lafayette inventory has narrowed their choices.

Pillar II - Presenting the Wine Cellar, the Grounds, and the Finishes at the Level They Deserve

A 2,000-bottle wine cellar with a tasting room, Venetian plaster throughout 5,300 square feet, and a fully equipped outdoor kitchen on nearly an acre are not features that show themselves in a standard MLS photo set. Each of these elements has a specific visual story that needs to be told in a way that stops a buyer mid-scroll. BrightWork's Sky Tour adds aerial context that communicates the lot scale and the setting in ways that ground photography cannot, and our cinematic photography standard is built to capture the character of homes like this one rather than just document the rooms.

Pillar III - Managing the Offer Process in a Way That Reflects the Home's Value

At this price point, how an offer is received and managed sends a signal about the property. A disorganized or passive offer process can undercut months of strong marketing in a single conversation. BrightWork uses the Final Offer platform to give buyers full visibility into activity and structure their offers in real time, which keeps serious buyers engaged and gives sellers a transparent view of real demand. The result is a process that feels as professional as the home itself, and that's exactly what a buyer committing to \$4 million expects.

A DIFFERENT OPTION: THE QUIET LISTING

Sell Without the Disruption

A traditional listing puts a sign in your yard, opens your door to strangers every weekend, and puts your home's history on public record. For a home that already went through one listing cycle, there's a better starting point.

BrightWork maintains an active private buyer list through our off-market platform. These are Bay Area buyers who've opted in specifically to receive property alerts before anything hits Zillow. They're motivated, pre-qualified, and they believe an off-market home represents a real opportunity, which means they engage seriously.

- * **No public days on market.** The prior listing history stays private. A new buyer sees none of it.
- * **No sign, no open houses, no disruption.** The sale is a private conversation between a motivated buyer and a motivated seller.
- * **Option to go public anytime.** If the right off-market offer doesn't materialize in an agreed window, we transition directly into a full relaunch strategy with no time lost.

* HOW IT WORKS

We alert our private buyer list through offmarket.brightworkrealty.com - Bay Area buyers specifically seeking properties before they go public. If a serious match emerges within the agreed window, we negotiate and close privately. If not, we launch the full relaunch strategy immediately, with clean momentum and no days-on-market exposure.

TIMELINE: THE BRIGHTWORK SMART WAY

Phase 1 - Pre-Market Preparation (Weeks 1–2)

Staging, full media production, and a Coming Soon campaign - or a quiet listing launch to our private buyer network, depending on your preference.

Phase 2 - Strategic Launch (Week 3)

Thursday launch on Zillow Showcase with the full media package in premium placement. Targeted SF/Oakland digital ads go live the same day.

Phase 3 - Momentum Management (Weeks 4–5)

Active follow-up on every save, inquiry, and open house visitor. Final Offer gives serious buyers a transparent channel to submit competitive offers.

Phase 4 - The Close (Weeks 6–7)

We engineer competition, not just field offers. Our process keeps both sides of the transaction moving cleanly toward a close.

WHY BRIGHTWORK REALTY ADVOCATES

- * **Deep local roots:** 45+ years in Moraga, Lafayette, and Orinda. Ground-level knowledge of what buyers in each community are actually paying for.
- * **Premium marketing as a baseline:** Cinematic photography, floor plans, 3D tours, and Sky Tours on every listing. Not a luxury add-on.
- * **Portal dominance:** Zillow Showcase and homes.com premium placement. More views, enhanced listing pages, all leads to your team.
- * **Modern offer tools:** Final Offer gives buyers a transparent path to engage and gives you real-time demand data in one place.
- * **True advocacy:** We don't re-list homes. We forensically review what went wrong and rebuild the strategy from the ground up.

This home has real assets that the market never got to properly evaluate. That's a correctable problem. The window to correct it is still open.

Ready to talk? brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727

Scan to see what a relaunch looks like for your home: relaunch.brightworkrealty.com

Important Notice

If you have entered into a listing agreement or active representation agreement with a licensed real estate agent in connection with this property, please disregard this mailing.

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The market analysis and strategic observations contained in this report are based on publicly available listing data and BrightWork's professional assessment of market conditions. They are not a formal appraisal and should not be relied upon as a certified valuation.

All property data referenced in this report was obtained from public records and MLS history. BrightWork Realty Advocates makes no warranty as to the accuracy of third-party data sources.

brightworkrealty.com · (925) 255-9727 · 455 Moraga Road, Suite I, Moraga, CA 94556